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WHAT'S NEW?

by indiefferential

PAUL MASON | WHAT'S NEW SEP VOL .2

Paul Mason

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Do you remember that time you discovered your favorite band? What was that like? How did it feel? Over the years we have found different ways of discovering new music and other formats of entertainment. Some of you already remember the first time you bought a vinyl record or a CD.

For me, it was one of the best experiences when I bought an AC/DC CD freshly bought ready to be played at full volume in my parent's Hi-Fi system. The physical aspect of the release always was something that stayed with me for a long time and I loved the whole experience of having that CD, inserting it into the system, controlling the volume and listening to my favorite tracks over and over again. Everything that came along with the CD was a bonus, you could look at pictures, read about the band and have something to do while experiencing their music.

Right now most music is released in digital formats and you can't really experience this. Magazines were also something that introduced me to my favorite bands back in the day. I remember reading about the Killers long before listening to their hits on the radio. Still, the physical aspect of the discovery was significant, for me at least. Of course, it's a lot easier to find out great music these days and not buy seven different CDs to discover what you like.

Enough with the past though, let's move to today, you can stream music, films and series and many people don't bother buying magazines or CDs. I am one of these people who loves to collect things and I also own many video games in digital and physical format. Even though some of my favorite video games are in a library on my computer, I always cherish the time I take to look through the case of an older video game, its pamphlets and artwork.

This is one of the reasons we started Indiefferential. The experience of holding a physical magazine in your hands, reading about these new bands from the other side of the world while you listen to their music online sending them a DM that you love their work. This is what Indiefferential is all about, keeping the good aspects of physical releases and combining this experience with the modern opportunities technology provides.

Indiefferential is here for every artist out there, we love what we do and we will keep posting about your music and projects so people can find out their new favorite artist. Our plan is to post consistently about new artists and creators, in that way, your audience will find out about another great band and their audience will discover your work. This is how Indiefferential works, always supporting artists in order to find the right audience and have their work sent across the whole world.

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Garry Pitcairn: From Desert Isolation to Apocalyptic Rock: A Journey Through Sound and Survival

Born on a remote island in the heart of the Po Valley desert, Garry Pitcairn emerged from the ashes of his former band, Anubi, to carve out a singular musical path. His debut album, I'll See You In The Trees (2014), was a solitary labor of love, entirely written, played, mixed, and produced by Pitcairn himself, shaped by the stark, unforgiving desert landscape that fueled its raw emotional core. To bring his vision to life on stage, Pitcairn formed the Garry Pitcairn Orchestra, which laid the groundwork for his sophomore album The Gospel (2019).

Now Playing...

This record marked an evolution, blending desert rock's gritty textures and psychedelic undertones with brooding singer-songwriter introspection inspired by icons such as Michael Gira, Nick Cave, and Mark Lanegan. The album's atmospheric depth attracted the attention of renowned producer Alain Johannes, collaborator with Lanegan, Queens of the Stone Age, Chris Cornell, and PJ Harvey, who mixed the entire project, elevating Pitcairn's sound to a new cinematic intensity.

As the world darkened, so too did Pitcairn's outlook. Relocating to the vibrant yet chaotic cityscape of Rome to escape mysterious epidemic outbreaks, he forged a new creative alliance with local musicians Flavio Di Giuseppe (drums) and Gianluca Bonetti (bass). Together, they are crafting Fiesta Forever, a raw, apocalyptic songbook that channels the destructive power of Italian rock music like never before.

The lead single, "People Eat People," slated for release in September 2025, is a bold statement, two original tracks by Pitcairn plus a haunting live cover of a Portishead classic, designed to be experienced intimately on headphones while the world around you rages in celebration. This new chapter promises a haunting blend of survival, chaos, and relentless sonic exploration that redefines the boundaries of modern rock.

With a particular emphasis on the experiences of the Mvskoke-Creek Nation, deaf multi-disciplinary artist Dead Feather has devoted his work to investigate themes of assimilation, identity, and cultural resilience. His newest work, *Cate Heleswv (Red Medicine) Vol. 1*, is a groundbreaking audio sculpture that blurs the line between personal expression and cultural preservation.

American Dreams is at its heart a single that condenses centuries of shared suffering, survival, and hope into a work of art both close and mercilessly strong. *American Dreams*, which is set for release on July 22, 2025, is much more than a tune. It is a story spun from the threads of memory, relocation, and generational conflict. The song also honors Dead Feather, who has long embraced the difficulties of being a self-taught deaf artist, as proof that music is not limited to sound; it reaches to the body, vibrations, and spirit as well.

To bring his vision to life, Dead Feather worked alongside instrumentalists and audio engineers Adam Stanley and Issac Nelson at Remote Studios in Wellston, Oklahoma. Together, they built a soundscape where rock's raw intensity intersects with reflective lyricism, crafting an experience that feels simultaneously cathartic and confrontational. The production, at once heavy and spacious, mirrors the weight of the history it carries while still leaving room for moments of grace and uplift.



feature

Dead Feather: Carving Sound from Silence with American Dreams

At its core, *American Dreams* grapples with the historical mistreatment of Native American communities by the United States, exposing how assimilation and forced “civilization” stripped away identities while planting seeds of generational trauma. Yet, Dead Feather does not stop at recounting loss, his work strives to reclaim narrative power. By fusing his own lived experience with a broader cultural reflection, the track becomes a vessel for both mourning and renewal.

For Dead Feather, art has always been more than aesthetics; it is activism, healing, and memory. His choice to call the album *Cate Heleswv (Red Medicine)* speaks to this philosophy. Red medicine, in the Mvskoke-Creek worldview, is more than a color or herb, it symbolizes strength, balance, and survival. This symbolism runs throughout the project, echoing in each note and lyric, anchoring it in cultural knowledge while inviting listeners of all backgrounds into dialogue.

The upcoming release of *American Dreams* also situates *Dead Feather* in a larger conversation about representation in music. As a deaf artist, he subverts mainstream expectations of what a musician “should” be. As a Native artist, he pushes against the flattening of Indigenous stories into stereotypes. And as a multi-discipline creative, he refuses to be bound by medium, instead letting the message dictate the form, whether through music, visual art, or performance.

American Dreams is just the beginning of what promises to be an evocative and uncompromising body of work; *Cate Heleswv (Red Medicine) Vol. 1* is approaching. It is music intended to inspire empathy, stir the bones, and remind listeners that history is not gone, it is experienced every day. Dead Feather's art is in the truths he forces us to face as well as in the noises he makes. Excitement grows for what this project will mean as July 22 approaches, both for the Mvskoke-Creek community and for listeners looking for music with depth, urgency, and cultural resonance. Dead Feather transforms silence into something timeless: a voice not to be disregarded, with *American Dreams*.



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For almost 15 years, Paul Mason has been the guitarist other musicians call when they need brilliance, whether it's Jessica Mauboy dominating festival stages, Sting and Harry Connick Jr. in full flight, or James Morrison granting a young Mason a jazz scholarship that would alter the trajectory of his life. But with his next song *The Other Guy*, released on August 8, Mason shows once again that he is not only a sideman for legends, he is a performer in his own right, forging a passionate and soulful musical route.

Paul Mason Steps Into the Spotlight with The Other Guy



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Mason will commemorate the release with a formal launch concert on August 15 at Sydney's Petersham Bowling Club, accompanied by guest Necko. For admirers who know him as the technical virtuoso behind endless studio sessions and live performances, *The Other Guy* will strike a familiar and insightful chord: a pure, truthful song combining feeling with the level of mastery Mason can provide. Mason is among the most renowned guitar players Australia has. That is not exaggeration.

His peers and critics alike have praised his remarkable capacity to From jazz and blues to rock, pop, and experimental, move effortlessly across genres. Mason has performed with Christine Anu, Vera Blue, Rai Thistlethwaite, Kate Miller-Heidke, and others, in addition to his long-term role as Jessica Mauboy's lead guitarist, as his résumé shows. A National Jazz Awards finalist, he is proof that his improvisational background is as important as his rock 'n' roll edge.

Still, Mason's career is not solely determined by with whom he has played. He has developed a solo channel in recent years that exposes a very different facet of his creativity. During the his tribute show Paul Mason Plays the Music of Jeff Beck sold out legendary venues like The Factory Theatre and Her Majesty's Theatre. Confirming both his capacity to respect his influences and his own terms ability to enthrall audiences, the Adelaide International Guitar Festival Mason will lead the Melbourne Guitar Show and perform at the Girrakool Music Festival in the future, where his playing will once more be central.

The Other Guy brings about change. Filled with technical ability and emotional grit, the single is personal but vast. "It's a daring step in my artistic development," Mason says. "Honest, soulful, and musically potent." While anchored by Mason's unmistakable guitar voice, the song invites listeners into his inner world and examines themes of identity, vulnerability, and tenacity. It's music that connects rather than merely impress. Mason's impact is also quite far from the platform. As Make Music Day Australia's ambassador, he supports music education and pushes for national access to guarantee that the following generation of Musicians have the inspiration and means to keep the torch forward. Giving back to the community is just as vital for him as headlining a concert or releasing a single.

Mason is no longer the moniker on the liner notes or the spotlighted guitarist behind another celebrity with The Other Guy. He is the narrative, the voice, the focus. It also presents fans and newcomers a chance to witness Paul Mason as an artist whose work surpasses genre, borders, and conventions, rather than only as a musician.

One thing becomes evident as the single drops and the Petersham Bowlo fills with its live debut: Paul Mason is not entering into the spotlight – he has always been there. This time, however, the light points squarely on him.



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Dallas-based musician Zac Yevette channels a lifetime of musical immersion into a genre he calls Cinematic Nu Metal, a fusion of heavy rock, alt-metal, and early 2000s hip-hop sensibilities. A one-man band with a mastery of multiple instruments, Yevette draws on influences as diverse as Deftones, The Smashing Pumpkins, Elliott Smith, Sade, and Kendrick Lamar, crafting music that is simultaneously heavy, introspective, and euphoric. His goal is to create songs that evoke emotion people cannot always articulate, blending sonic intensity with visual storytelling. His latest single, Apples and Hedonism, released on August 15, embodies this ethos. Written around the idea of biting into forbidden fruit and chasing pleasure, the track balances crushing alt-

metal walls of sound with vocals that soothe, guiding the listener through both intensity and longing. The song evokes a timeless yearning reminiscent of 90s R&B, but filtered through Yevette's unique, cinematic lens. Contributions from friends elevate the release: Gabriel Alcantara on bass, Yellow Jones on the guitar solo, and Chandler

Filmed in skate parks, run-down motels, and dry cleaners, the video's high-energy visuals, quick cuts, and guitar close-ups amplify the track's nostalgic, rebellious aesthetic.

Zac Yevette: Cinematic Nu Metal and the Euphoria of "Apples and Hedonism"

Sneed on drums, all weaving into Yevette's vision. He mixed, mastered, and produced the accompanying music video, color grading and editing to craft a cohesive audiovisual experience. Filmed in skate parks, run-down motels, and dry cleaners, the video's high-energy visuals, quick cuts, and guitar close-ups amplify the track's nostalgic, rebellious aesthetic.

Apples and Hedonism is a vivid, multi-sensory exploration of desire, pleasure, and memory, a song that turns introspection into euphoria and heaviness into exhilaration.



Heathen Kings: Creating Epic Metal in I Am Become Death

I Am Become Death (Destroyer of Worlds), the most recent song by Heathen Kings, is evidence of the band's audacious mix of heavy metal and strength. metal, rich with subtle textures that lift their trademark sound. Recorded over several sessions at home, the song was a labor of love influenced by friendship and teamwork that let the band explore both grandiose and intimate, intimate artistic expression and metal conventions. While deeper thrash undercurrents anchor the song in traditional influences like Iron Maiden, Judas Priest, and Helloween, the soaring vocals, harmonized guitars, and galloping drums define its basis. and elegant 80s-inspired clean guitar textures provide the band's sound with new dimensions.

Essential for the launch was the knowledge of Ed Sokolowski, whose mastering and mixing skills span musicians including Melanie C, Fleur East, Becky Hill, along with the worldwide hit 220 Kid & Billen Ted Wellerman Remix. His sense of space and precision guaranteed that the complex layers of the song—from light intros to catastrophic choral outros—shined clearly and powerfully. Longtime friend Charlie Johnston designed the striking album cover to complement the music, visually reflecting the epic and melancholy tones of the song.

The song itself tells a story of ethical complexity, examining Robert Oppenheimer's great remorse and contradictory feelings regarding the construction of the atomic bomb. With musical fervor, Heathen Kings mix historical introspection with musical intensity, using both melody and fierceness to reflect the stress of human conscience and huge impact. Becoming I am Death is important for its dynamic execution as well as for its thematic complexity, arranging subdued, clean guitar sections against thundering riffs and apocalyptic chorals. It shows how the band has evolved by honoring traditional metal while venturing into new emotional and musical ground.



Exclusive Feature

Hypnagogia is more than a musical alias, it is the summation of Elijah Durnell's multifaceted artistry. A self-contained force, Elijah handles songwriting, performance, editing, and production with a steady hand, allowing the project to retain a deeply personal voice while still resonating on a universal scale.

The newest Hypnagogia release, the creative vessel of South Bend native Elijah Durnell, mixes darkness, tension, beauty, and resilience. With the release of *Last Light/When It All Ends* (Extended Single) on September 5, 2025, Elijah not only solidifies his reputation as a visionary musician and producer but also demonstrates the capacity to transform environment and feeling into a really cinematic event.

Hypnagogia represents the whole of Elijah's varied artistic output; it is more than just a musical moniker. Elijah manages songwriting, performance, editing, and production with a calm hand, a self-contained force, allowing the project to maintain a very personal voice while yet relating on a global level. This balance is evident in the next extended single: deeply introspective but intended to move bodies on dim dancefloors.

Last Light/When It All Ends is fundamentally a voyage through themes of loss, tenacity, and reclaiming. Inspired by the emotional intensity of The Cure and the industrial roughness of Nine Inch Nails, Elijah creates something from Goth, Darkwave, and Post-Punk. That seems familiar but markedly different. His sound flourishes in contrasts—hard beats matched with ambient synths, raw emotion layered over immaculate production—producing music that is both vulnerable and relentlessly strong.

The long single is more than just a two-track release. Five tracks feature the original songs, two remixes created by Derek Christopher of The Joy Thieves, and the eerie instrumental closing, *Flicker*. Every song helps to tell a narrative arc that seems very movie-like.

The original versions of *Last Light* and *When It All Ends* lean into Elijah's ability for layering industrial textures with melodic imagery; Christopher's remixes are reframing the songs for various listening experiences injects fresh energy. The last song, *Flicker*, completely removes the voice to create a mesmerizing instrumental scene that reflects the subtle interaction of light and shadow, decay and perseverance. "The release examines both the individual and the global," Elijah notes. "It's about seeking to recover what once felt familiar—

textures, while the lyrical sensitivity guarantees the songs last long after the final beat fades. It's music to process, to cry with, and to come out stronger from—not just songs to dance to. As *Last Light/When It All Ends* (Extended Single) prepares to drop, listeners are invited to step into Elijah's world, one that is shadowed yet illuminated, despairing yet defiantly alive. It's a release that refuses to sit quietly in the background; it demands attention, reflection, and movement. With this release, Hypnagogia proves itself a rising

Hypnagogia Emerges from the Shadows with Last Light/When It All Ends (Extended Single)

the events, persons, or areas that feel lost—and confronting the truth that they might never come back in the same form." The emotional ambiguity of Hypnagogia's work—the simultaneous tug of nostalgia and the drive toward survival—strikes resonance.

Musically, the extended single succeeds at the intersection of simplicity and passion. The club floor benefits from the pounding industrial beats and distorted

force, one capable of bridging the intimate and the immense, the personal and the universal. It's music born of silence and struggle, but also of fire and persistence. And in its flickering glow, Elijah Durnell's artistry shines unmistakably bright.



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From the quiet corners of Greater London emerges Pisgah, a rising artist whose music feels less like a performance and more like an intimate conversation carried on the wind. On September 5, 2025, Pisgah releases their latest single, Cumulonimbus—a track that captures both the turbulence and the beauty of human experience.

With influences as eclectic as Cassandra Jenkins, Emma Ruth Rundle, and Grouper, Pisgah has carved out a sound that balances the ethereal with the deeply personal. It's music built on atmosphere: dreamy, layered instrumentation paired with lyrics that don't just tell stories but unravel them slowly, like weather patterns forming across an unsettled sky.

At its heart, Cumulonimbus is about reflection and inheritance. Pisgah uses the shifting volatility of storm clouds as a metaphor for the cycles of generational trauma, exploring how emotional weight is passed down, transformed, and sometimes endured in silence. The imagery is both visceral and universal; clouds gather, storms break, and yet, within it all, there is release, healing, and even beauty.

Recorded in the intimacy of Pisgah's home studio, the track carries a sense of raw honesty. Every detail—from the careful layering of textures to the haunting vocal delivery—feels intentional, but never over-constructed. This is music that breathes. The single was given its final polish by acclaimed producer Dan Duszynski, whose mixing and mastering elevated the track's atmosphere without stripping away its soul. The result is a song that drifts effortlessly between fragility and force, pulling listeners into its emotional weather system.

"Pisgah's artistic evolution feels both organic and intentional. Early works hinted at their ability to build immersive soundscapes, but Cumulonimbus is confident without being overbearing, atmospheric without becoming abstract, and deeply personal while remaining universally relatable."



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What makes Pisgah's work stand out is the balance of vulnerability and strength. The melodies are lush and hypnotic, inviting the listener into a dreamlike haze, while the lyrics ground the experience with unflinching honesty. It's this combination that places Pisgah alongside their influences while allowing them to carve an unmistakably personal identity. Cumulonimbus isn't just a single, it's a glimpse into the greater journey Pisgah has been crafting.

Pisgah's artistic evolution feels both organic and intentional. Early works hinted at their ability to build immersive soundscapes, but Cumulonimbus marks a distinct step forward. It's confident without being overbearing, atmospheric without becoming abstract, and deeply personal while remaining universally relatable. For fans of evocative storytelling set to music that lingers long after the final note, Pisgah's latest release is not just a song, but an experience.

Pisgah Unveils Cumulonim bus: A Storm of Sound and Emotion

The song serves as a bridge toward their forthcoming album, Faultlines, set for release on November 7, 2025. If the single is any indication, the album promises to be a profound exploration of emotional landscapes, weaving together stories of fracture, resilience, and self-discovery.

As storms gather and dissipate, as skies clear and shadows fade, Cumulonimbus leaves behind its echo, a reminder that even in turbulence, there is transformation. With this release, Pisgah doesn't just share a song; they share a part of their journey.



*Trashy Annie Rewrites Rock Rules with Her Own “Crazy B*tch”*

*This is Trashy Annie at her finest: raw, loud, and
unfiltered.*

Austin's own unapologetic rock outlaw Trashy Annie has never been one to play it safe. With her latest release, she takes on one of rock's most infamous and divisive anthems, Buckcherry's "Crazy B*tch" and transforms it into something distinctly her own. Where the original thrived on raunchy bravado, Annie reclaims the song with punk grit, outlaw country swagger, and her signature dive-bar ferocity, proving once again that she's fearless in both voice and vision.

For years, "Crazy B*tch" has been celebrated, condemned, and debated for its raw lyrics and unapologetic energy. Some wrote it off as nothing more than shock value, while others embraced its audacity as pure rock 'n' roll spirit. Trashy Annie, however, saw something different, an opportunity to flip the script. Her version doesn't just pay homage to the track; it reframes it, reclaiming its rebellious energy with a perspective that's both bold and unflinchingly her own.

The result is a cover that feels as dirty and unfiltered as the original but stamped with Annie's unmistakable identity. It's loud, it's gritty, and it's unapologetically trashy in the best way possible. Vocally, Annie injects the track with a bite that feels more rebellious and more dangerous than ever. Her delivery radiates the confidence of someone who's fought her way through smoky bars and rowdy crowds, earning every ounce of authenticity she brings to the stage.

Vocally, Annie injects the track with a bite that feels more lived-in, more rebellious, and more dangerous than ever.

Trashy Annie is no stranger to bending genres or breaking expectations. Since storming onto the scene, she's blurred the lines between punk rock chaos, outlaw country grit, and classic dive-bar rowdiness. Her songs don't just fit into one lane; they crash into them all, unapologetically messy and thrillingly authentic. It's a style that has quickly earned her a loyal fan base drawn to her raw honesty and unpolished edge. The release of "Crazy B*tch" comes on the heels of her fan-favorite tracks "Sugar" and "Some Strange," songs that further cemented her reputation as one of the most fearless rising voices in American rock.

Each track shows her knack for taking risks and her refusal to water down her music for the sake of convention. With "Crazy B*tch", Annie goes one step further — taking a song that many wouldn't dare touch and making it her own rebellious anthem.



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"Crazy B*tch" in Annie's hands is more than a cover. It's a declaration. A reminder that rock 'n' roll at its best is about rebellion, ownership, and refusing to apologize for who you are. By reclaiming the notorious track, she gives it new life, stamping it with a fresh, fierce, and uncompromising spirit.

This is Trashy Annie at her finest: raw, loud, and unfiltered. Whether on a backroad stage, a crowded dive bar, or blasting through your speakers, her version of "Crazy B*tch" isn't just a performance, it's a shot of adrenaline straight to the heart of rock 'n' roll.



For many artists, a song may represent a watershed moment not only in music but also in identity. For London-based producer Finlay, *Waiting for You* means precisely that. Launched on August 28, 2025, the song marks a new chapter in his musical development, replacing his Hip-Hop instrumental origins with a daring and inventive *Enter the world of House music*.

The song combines influences across generations very naturally. Finlay finds harmony between these traditional roots and the original inventiveness of modern artists like Ari Bald, Jamie xx, and Barry Can't Swim. The outcome is a song that seems timeless yet contemporary and a performance that captures the joyful pulse of House while still having a reflective, personal edge.

Two years in the making, "*Waiting for You*" starts in an unusual place. Finlay was at his grandparents' kitchen table in July 2023 with little more than his laptop and a spark of inspiration. He had drawn the rough outline of what would eventually become his first official House release in ten minutes. Originally a spontaneous experiment, what soon became a project ate up his attention, undergoing numerous drafts, adjustments, and rethinks before he ultimately decided to let it go out into the world.

Finlay says, noting the perfectionism many producers encounter, "I figured I could not keep re-producing it always." Every version of the song brought something fresh: a more hypnotic rhythm, a richer bass texture, a minor melodic change, but ultimately he realized that the song's core had always been there in that first ten-minute sketch.

The publication of "*Waiting for You*" is as much about closure as it is about artistic development; it is about an artist knowing when to stop fiddling and Trust the music to speak for itself.

Musically, the song exhibits all the signs of excellent House: layered percussion, ambient builds, pulsating grooves, and an irresistible sense of forward movement. Still, there is also something very intimate about it. Though maybe it's the reflective undertones or the emotional weight of its title, *Waiting for You* awakens something more subtle in the listener than simply movement of bodies. Reveling fresh textures and emotions with every listen, it's the kind of song ideally suited for solitary headphone sessions and late-night dancefloors.

*Finlay Breaks
New Ground
with
"Waiting for
You"*

Its impact in defining Finlay's identity as an artist makes this release especially important for him. Having spent years developing his talent in Hip-Hop instrumentals, he welcomed House as both a challenge and an opportunity. The change shows more general investigation of how his music can combine rhythm, environment, and emotion rather than just a shift in genre. It's a voyage of re-discovery, in which ancient influences harmonize with new interests. Finlay places himself at the crossroads of nostalgia and creativity





with “Waiting for You”. This song honors the forefathers of House while creating room for his own unique voice. It's more than just a release; it's evidence that occasionally the finest work comes from grabbing a moment and letting it grow organically rather than from chasing perfection. Waiting for You creates the mood for what is to follow: music that is thoughtful yet visceral, greatly influenced but very unique, as Finlay enters this new age. It's not only a House track. That's the noise of an artist discovering his rhythm.



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In the global world of experimental electronic music, few artists embody the collision of sound, art, and digital culture quite like DARYNKA. Born in Ukraine and now living nomadically between San Francisco, Dubai, and Bangkok, she occupies the liminal spaces of identity, constantly shifting and evolving much like her music. A former art curator with a background in visual storytelling, DARYNKA brings a unique perspective to her sonic craft, blending conceptual art practices with emotionally charged soundscapes. Her work sits at the intersection of music, performance, and philosophy—an exploration of what it means to be human in a hyper-digital world.

Her upcoming EP, *body.404*, is a hauntingly intimate reflection on the dissolution and transformation of the self. As its title suggests, the project embraces the disorienting logic of a digital error: the body as something lost, inaccessible, or in flux. Within its tracks, the listener is invited to step into a world where intimacy no longer requires touch, where desire is unanchored from form, and where identity becomes a constant negotiation between presence and absence. The body, for DARYNKA, is never static—it's uploaded, extended, sensual, and unstable all at once.

Musically, DARYNKA operates within the realm of experimental electronic sound design, though her style defies simple categorization. *body.404* is less an EP in the conventional sense and more a sculptural experience in sound. Each track builds like an emotional architecture, fragile yet sharp, dissolving form in favor of atmosphere, tension, and sensory depth. Drawing on deconstructed club music, cinematic layering, and a hyper-personal vocal presence, she

device but a core element of the composition. By letting songs evolve unpredictably, DARYNKA resists traditional structures. The result is music that unfolds less like a story and more like an encounter: one that demands to be felt as much as it is heard. In her universe, fragility is not weakness but a new form of strength, a way to experience emotion in its most raw, unguarded state. What makes DARYNKA's work so compelling is the way it straddles the line between art

instability of its form. Her nomadic lifestyle further deepens this exploration of instability and transformation. Constantly moving between cities, cultures, and communities, she mirrors this transience in her work. For DARYNKA, identity is never singular or fixed—it's constantly negotiated, refracted through shifting environments and technologies. *body.404* is the sonic expression of this reality: the self as fragmented but alive, broken yet radiant in its multiplicity.

If *body.404* has a central theme, it's that the digital era has transformed not only how we interact but also who we are. Our bodies exist in many states simultaneously, on screens, in memories, in networks, and in touch. Desire becomes data, intimacy becomes mediated, and the line between the real and the virtual dissolves. DARYNKA doesn't mourn this shift. Instead, she captures it in sound, offering listeners a fragile, fluid poetics for the age of digital embodiment.

With *body.404*, DARYNKA asserts herself as more than a producer, she is a sonic architect of contemporary identity, building spaces where sound, art, and emotion collide. Her music may be unstable, but in its instability lies the possibility of transformation, connection, and new ways of being.

As she prepares to release *body.404*, one thing becomes clear: DARYNKA is not just making music. She is crafting a vision of the self in the digital era, fractured but deeply human.

DARYNKA

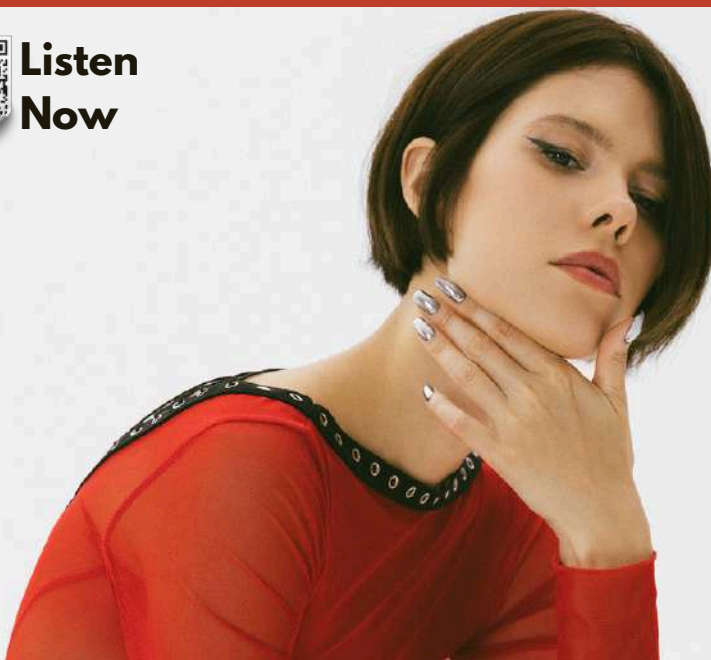
Explores the Fragility of Identity in body.404

creates immersive sonic environments that feel both intimate and alien. Disrupted beats pulse against atmospheric pads, processed textures bend into unfamiliar shapes, and fragments of voice recordings hover like digital ghosts. Her vocal delivery, sometimes whispered, sometimes broken apart and reassembled, is not simply a lyrical

installation and club culture. Her background as a curator informs her approach: every sound, every silence, every texture is placed with intent, like brushstrokes in a painting or sculptural forms in a gallery. Yet, there's nothing cold or detached about her practice. On the contrary, her music pulses with intimacy, its vulnerability heightened by the



**Listen
Now**



Scottish musician and composer Joe Sensible has earned a name for writing songs that go against convention while maintaining a basis in emotional honesty. His music is grounded in his unique fingerstyle acoustic guitar playing, which imbues his songs with a smooth, textured character. Though his songs have abstract tendencies, they always have significance and frequently pull listeners into a contemplative place where memories, location, and emotion meet.

Joe welcomes listeners into a sonic time capsule of his 20s with his self-produced second album, a time characterized by exploration, honesty, and creative development. With overlapping vocals and guitar lines acting as landmarks within a huge, sweeping musical landscape, the record promises to be both close-up and far-reaching.



Every fresh single from the project exposes a different aspect of Joe's creativity, therefore highlighting his range and the breadth of his inspirations. Latin Grammy-winning engineer Luiz Tornaghi mastered the record, a fact emphasizing Joe's commitment to both quality and craft. With subdued power, the new song "Second Chance" personifies these ideals. Written on a summer evening by a secluded riverbank, the song practically came to life. While playing an old guitar with a subdued, natural tone, Joe explains how he zones out to



the beat of the river. The song wrote itself in that brief pause, a gentle reminder of how music sometimes appears uninvited when emotion and surroundings coincide. The capacity of Second Chance to depict a setting as well as a sensation is what gives it especially persuasive power. The

song evokes the seclusion of a secret location, the surge of water resounding throughout its beats, and the quiet of loneliness. By placing the acoustic instruments front and center and interweaving textured reverbs, delays, and delicate instrumental levels, the production choices help to

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maintain the atmosphere of its origin. Joe's sensitivity as both a songwriter and producer is reflected in his choice to allow the song to breathe rather than flood it with extreme manufacturing. The cello and electric bass guitar techniques, which add warmth and depth without overpowering

the song's frail center, are among its best points. These components create a dreamlike, sentimental environment, the kind of soundscape that feels both big and very personal. While *Second Chance* "doesn't make any big statements," Joe says it beautifully captures his emotions

in that fleeting moment at the water. The song's appeal comes from exactly this honesty. Though not meant to wow with greatness, this song aims to connect via subtlety, detail, and ambiance.

Much as the rest of Joe's next album, *Second Chance* demonstrates his will to fight conventional patterns in favor of music that is alive, fluid, and multidimensional. Every chord, lyrical layer helps create a song meant to be lived rather than just listened to.

Joe's work serves as a reminder of how music can capture both the universality of human as he keeps releasing singles from the project. The precision of personal memory and emotion. He provides listeners in *Second Chance* an invitation, to stop, ponder, and experience the gentle beauty of a moment held in time, not just a song.

Joe Sensible Redefines Intimacy in Second Chance



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JORDAN OLYMPUS BRIDGES WORLDS WITH NEW SINGLE OUTLANDER

Jordan Olympus unveils *Outlander*, a vibrant track that affirms his signature sound: Island Pop. Equal parts sensual and radiant, the single is a danceable journey into identity, belonging, and the beauty of living between cultures.

Born and raised among the intertwined cultures of the islands, Olympus channels that lived experience into a hybrid pop sound infused with Afro and tropical influences. *Outlander* pulses with an infectious afropop beat, its rhythms carrying listeners to sun-soaked shores while the lyrics dive deeper, exploring the complexities of growing up across cultural borders and the search for self within those in-between spaces.

From the very first beat, *Outlander* immerses listeners in an intoxicating blend of afropop rhythms and tropical melodies. The groove is immediate, sensual, radiant, and undeniably infectious. But beneath the celebratory sound lies a deeper current: Olympus's exploration of what it means to grow up between cultures, straddling worlds that sometimes clash but more often collide into something new and beautiful. It is this duality, between joy and introspection, celebration and reflection, that defines both the track and Olympus's artistry. Jordan Olympus describes his music as Island Pop, a genre he has cultivated to reflect his own Afro and Creole roots fused with a modern pop sensibility.

It's music that feels borderless yet intimate, a soundscape where island rhythms meet contemporary production, where ancestral echoes are reborn in sleek, danceable forms. *Outlander* serves as a quintessential expression of this philosophy: global in scope, but deeply personal in narrative. The track follows Olympus's earlier release, *Whine*, which established him as a fresh voice in the evolving pop scene. With *Outlander*, he pushes further, offering a song that not only invites listeners to move their bodies but also to reflect on their own journeys of identity and belonging. The song captures the sensation of being both at home and out of place, a paradox that many who live between cultures know all too well.

A music video, set for release shortly after the single, will bring this exploration to life visually. Expanding on the track's universe, the video promises to weave imagery of landscapes, movement, and emotion into a narrative that mirrors the themes of duality and discovery found in the music. For Olympus, the visual component is not just an accessory but a vital part of storytelling, another way to connect, communicate, and amplify the power of *Outlander*.

This single also marks the first step toward a broader project: an upcoming EP that will showcase the full spectrum of Olympus's influences and creative reach. Fans can expect a journey that continues to blend genres, cultures, and perspectives, affirming his status as a truly versatile and border-defying artist.



new
release



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Olympus's talent has not gone unnoticed. He has already been recognized by the Academy of Arts, Sciences and Letters of Paris, a testament to his unique artistry and contribution to contemporary music. His work, self-taught yet refined through training in Paris, stands at the intersection of authenticity and innovation.

Citing influences such as Amaarae and Tyla, Olympus situates himself within a new wave of artists redefining pop on their own terms. Like his inspirations, he balances vulnerability with strength, crafting songs that are at once deeply personal and universally resonant.

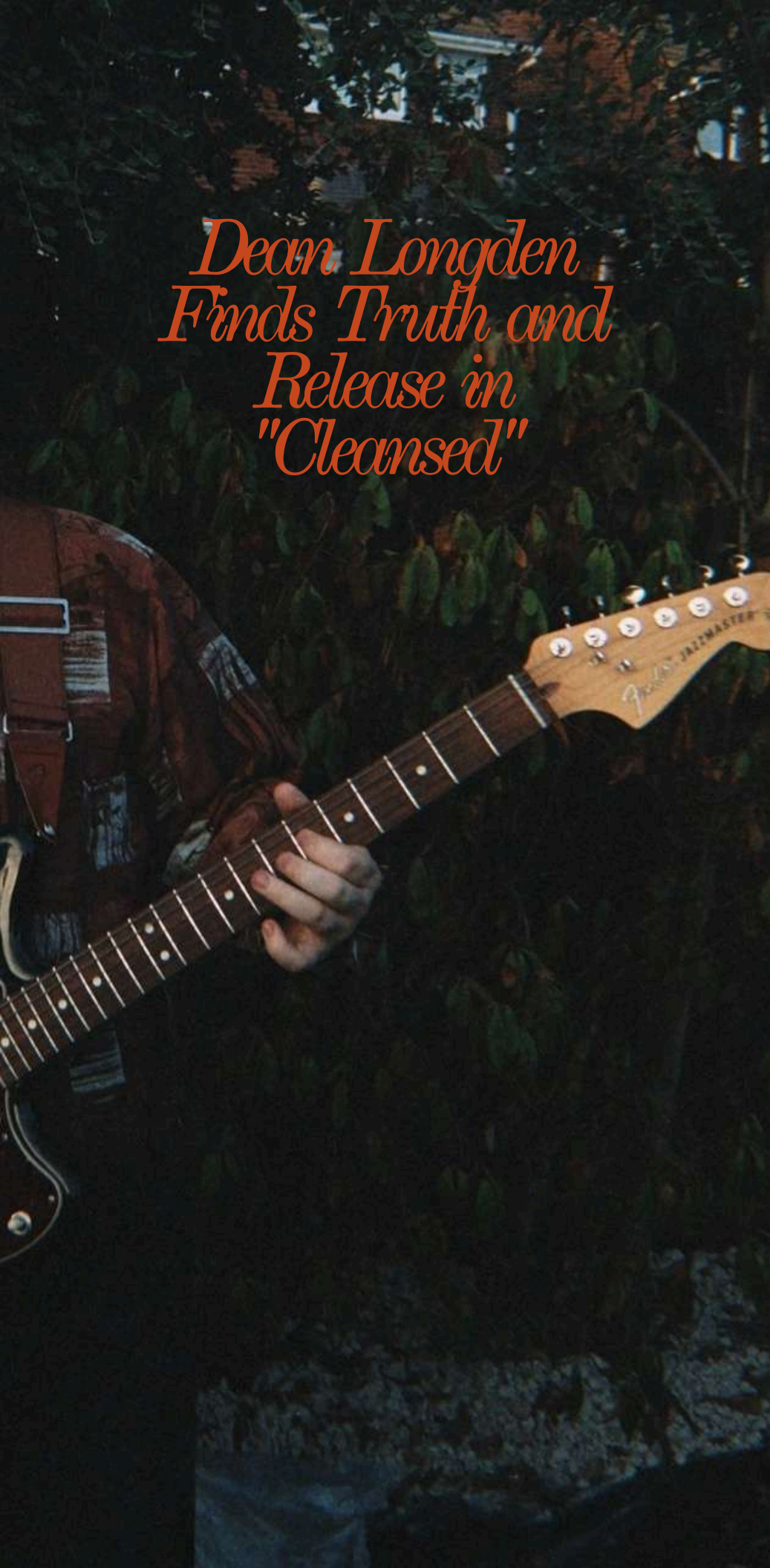
At its core, *Outlander* is about connection—between cultures, between rhythms, and between people. It's an invitation to dance, to feel, and to celebrate the messy, beautiful journey of identity. For Jordan Olympus, Island Pop is more than a genre. It's a movement, a vision, and a promise of music that transcends boundaries while remaining grounded in heritage.

With *Outlander*, Jordan Olympus solidifies himself not just as an artist to watch, but as a voice capable of reshaping the soundscape of global pop. His music doesn't just tell a story—it invites us to live it.

There is something magnetic about watching an artist arrive at a moment that feels inevitable. For Dean Longden, that moment comes with his upcoming single "Cleansed," a song born from an intimate emotional space and carried to life with the weight of experience and conviction. Longden, a London-born musician who has quietly built his craft over the years, has poured himself into this track, and the result is a work that speaks as much to his personal journey as it does to the universal themes of loss, resilience, and renewal. The path to "Cleansed" began in early 2025 with a chord progression that lingered in his head, one that first echoed the hushed acoustic tones of the band hey, nothing. What started softly began to shift, picking up a rawer energy, until the song took on a rockier character, reflecting the turbulence that inspired it. At its core is Longden's open tuning of DADF#BE, a choice that shapes the song's distinctive resonance. It gives the track a depth that feels both intimate and expansive, allowing his voice and lyrics to hover over the chords with an unflinching honesty. Yet Longden's sound does not emerge in isolation. The single carries the fingerprints of collaboration, with creative sparks added by his friend Fin and the careful, final shaping handled by producer Billy Rodgers.

Together they built on Longden's vision without dulling its edge, ensuring that the song's authenticity remained intact. Recorded at the Roundhouse in Camden, a space steeped in music history, "Cleansed" arrives as a statement of both personal and artistic growth, a track that could only have been written at this precise point in his life. For Longden, music has always been a form of reckoning. Growing up in London, he began experimenting with instruments in his teens, drawn first to guitar as a way to process the world around him. At a time when words often fell short, he found that sound could carry the weight of what he could not easily say. Early songwriting attempts were rough sketches, often half-finished ideas, but they planted the seed of a lifelong pursuit. Over time, he leaned into the vulnerability that came with performing his own material, discovering that the more personal the song, the more deeply it connected with others. That lesson has stayed with him, guiding not just "Cleansed" but the work he continues to write.



A photograph of a person playing a Fender Jazzmaster guitar. The person is wearing a brown leather jacket and is positioned in a dark, wooded area. The guitar is a light-colored Fender Jazzmaster with a dark fretboard. The person's hand is visible on the fretboard, and the guitar's headstock is visible. The background is dark and filled with foliage.

Dean Longden Finds Truth and Release in "Cleansed"

What makes Longden's new single compelling is not only its craftsmanship but its refusal to shy away from emotional complexity. His lyrics carry a bruised tenderness, confronting loss while also carving a path toward renewal. The production highlights this duality, with moments of quiet restraint giving way to surges of intensity. It is a song that does not settle for a single mood but instead embodies the shifting terrain of grief and growth.

The release of "Cleansed" on August 15, 2025, marks not just another milestone but the opening of a new chapter. With live performances ahead and an EP taking shape, Longden is preparing to expand the world he has been building song by song. What remains constant is his commitment to making music that feels lived-in and unguarded, work that does not flinch from truth but instead leans into it.

Dean Longden has arrived at a point where his voice feels unmistakably his own. "Cleansed" is not just a single but a marker of where he has been and where he is heading, a reminder that the most powerful songs are often the ones that come from laying everything bare.



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**"Cleansed" is a song
born from an
intimate emotional
space and carried to
life with the weight
of experience and
conviction.**

serving new music

BY INDIEFFERENTIAL

Zimzalabim Roars
With Heart of a Lion



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From the coastal city of Kalmar, Sweden, emerges Zimzalabim, the artistic alias of Patrik Byström, a multi-instrumentalist, songwriter, and producer whose music radiates both heart and conviction. On August 10, 2025, he unveils his latest original album, *Heart of a Lion*, a deeply personal and socially conscious body of work that bridges the intimate struggles of the self with the broader challenges of humanity.

What makes this project so striking is the sheer scope of Byström's involvement. As Zimzalabim, he is the album's beating heart—writing every lyric, playing every instrument, recording, and producing each track within the walls of his home studio. Yet, the record is not without its collaborative spirit: ethereal backing vocals from Angelica “Zionessa” Svensson weave through the songs, adding texture and warmth to the album's already expansive soundscape.

*The result is music that feels soul,
nourishing and universally relatable,
especially in today's climate where
many grapple with uncertainty
but search for meaning and
connection.*

Heart of a Lion is more than just a collection of songs; it is a reflection of Byström's journey, both personal and universal. Tracks like *Coming Our Way*, *Everyone's a Winner*, and the title track itself are driven by themes of resilience, hope, and unity. They capture the essence of overcoming adversity, whether it be loneliness, societal unrest, or the weight of collective struggles.

Zimzalabim's influences are worn proudly but never copied. Echoes of Bob Marley's humanitarian spirit course through the album, but the execution feels uniquely Byström's, marrying reggae-inspired grooves with introspective lyricism, folk sensibilities, and wide-ranging musical experimentation. It's this fearless blending of styles that makes his work feel both familiar and refreshing, drawing listeners in with comfort while challenging them to reflect.

Recording the album in Kalmar allowed Zimzalabim to craft something intimate yet far-reaching. His home studio becomes both sanctuary and springboard, where themes of loneliness and isolation are met with soaring affirmations of hope. The result is music that feels soul-nourishing and universally relatable, especially in today's climate where many grapple with uncertainty but search for meaning and connection.

What shines through *Heart of a Lion* is Byström's commitment to authenticity. The record doesn't chase trends or seek to fit neatly within a single genre—it flows where the emotion demands, sometimes dreamy and atmospheric, other times rhythmically uplifting. Angelica Svensson's harmonies elevate this journey, adding another dimension to Byström's already dynamic arrangements, and reminding listeners that even in solitude, there is community in sound.

As *Heart of a Lion* prepares to make its mark, Zimzalabim positions himself as more than just a musician, he is a storyteller, a seeker, and a voice for resilience. His album is not only a product of personal reflection but a mirror to the world's ongoing struggles and hopes. For listeners, it offers both solace and strength, a reminder that even in moments of fragility, the lion's heart within can still roar.

With this release, Zimzalabim doesn't simply add another record to his catalog, he offers a soundtrack for perseverance. Bold, heartfelt, and unflinchingly human, *Heart of a Lion* is poised to resonate with audiences far beyond Sweden, leaving an indelible mark on those who listen.

SHERWØØD UNVEILS A QUIET MASTERY WITH DEAR B

Sherwøød has always set himself apart as a flexible and profoundly introspective artist from London's energetic undercurrent; his most recent song, Dear B, more strengthens his image as a musician prepared to reveal his feelings. Published by Cruel Dagger on May 2, 2025, the song plays out as a quiet, reflective search of vulnerability by means of alternative, indie, R&B, and faint Hip-hop textures into a coherent, emotionally charged soundscape.

Dear B draws the audience right into its close environment created on minimal instrumentation and modest beats that let Sherwøød's voice command the foreground with clarity and warmth. The vocal delivery expresses a sophisticated sense of melancholy and the lingering echoes of unsaid farewells with a natural reverberation that sharpens its meditative tone. Penned in the wake of the abrupt termination of a deep relationship, the song channels extremely intimate emotions yet relates worldwide, encouraging listeners to face their own losses, distance, and silent pang of emotional disconnect. The outcome is a song that sounds confessional and cinematic, a reflective late-night friend that lingers long after the last note fades.

Sherwøød's artistic sensibility comes from a basis of demanding musical education ranging from cello, piano, bass, and guitar. This varied past influences a layered approach to songwriting and production in which organic instruments with understatement and restraint meet electronic components. In Dear B, these factors combine perfectly to produce a setting where ambient textures and minimal percussion frame the passionate vocals rather than vie with them. Providing listeners with a multidimensional experience of sound and emotion, it is a measured, intentional technique that raises the track beyond simple narrative.



Sherwøød has compiled an amazing discography over the years with albums including Pride, Dopamine, and Wait 4 U. Once more, everyone showed a readiness to investigate the areas between genres and emotional conditions. Dear B keeps this path, accepting vulnerability as a source of strength and connection rather than as a weakness. Sherwøød creates music that is both approachable and sophisticated, grabbing the listener into a very human story, by giving authenticity first priority and letting his own experiences influence the harmonic palette.



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Dear B acts both a prologue and a declaration of intent as excitement for his next self-titled EP grows, pointing to an artist in control of his view, craft, and voice. Sherwøød is ready to convert the introspective closeness of his studio work into a performance planned for the Far East Festival on May 31st. live venues let viewers have a real contact with his emotional spectrum.

Dear B is an invitation to observe the subdued power of emotional honesty, a reminder that music can say what words frequently cannot. With its delicate beats, sophisticated instrumentation, and honest vocal performances, Sherwøød confirms his position as one of London's most captivating musical voices able to transform individual introspection into a widely appealing listening experience.

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In the heart of Paris, a city long celebrated for its artistic spirit, Books Of Moods has emerged as one of the most intriguing indie art-rock projects to watch. Helmed by Hugo Sailer, the project brings together the textures of rock, indie, art rock, and pop into a sound that feels both nostalgic and refreshingly modern. With influences stretching from David Bowie and The Velvet Underground to Arcade Fire, Crumb, and Sales, Sailer has created a universe where retro energy meets contemporary introspection.

Since their debut in December 2023 with *Happiness*, *Sunday Mood*, and *Dreams*, Books Of Moods has showcased a remarkable gift for weaving dreamy, reflective melodies that act as both an escape and a mirror. Much like a musical madeleine de Proust, the songs trigger memory, warmth, and a serene sense of nostalgia.

Books Of Moods: Dreamscapes from Paris to the Sun

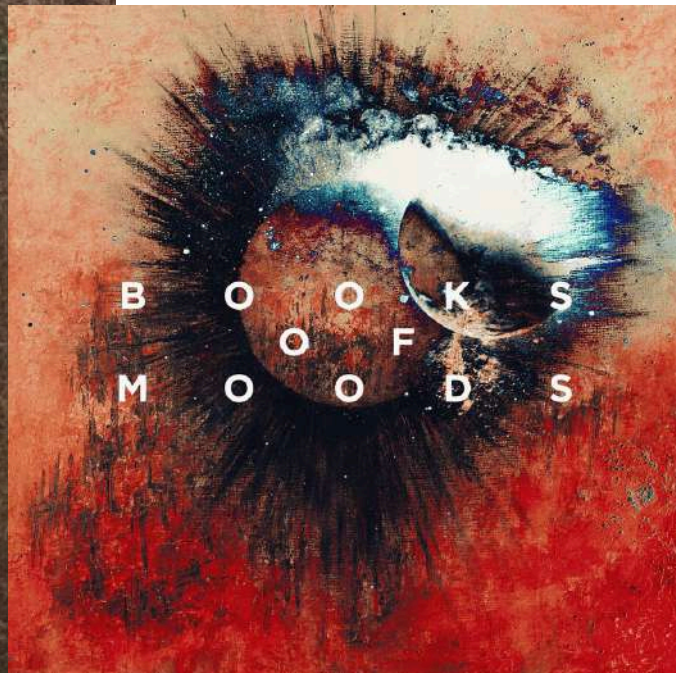
The storytelling at the core of Books Of Moods is what makes the project so compelling. Marrying the lyrical intimacy of The Beatles with the lush harmonies of '70s art rock, Sailer writes music that balances tranquility and curiosity, encouraging listeners to dream as much as they reflect. Now, Books Of Moods is ready to add another chapter with the release of *Holidays*, a shimmering track that perfectly embodies the chaotic joy of summer.





Written from the memory of a spontaneous getaway with friends, the song's laid-back 100 BPM groove and dreamy rock vibe capture the essence of long, sun-soaked days, late-night detours, and the kind of laughter that lingers. With playful lyrics and glowing production, Holidays becomes more than a song, it's a memory bottled into sound, ready to transport listeners to beaches, city streets, or wherever adventure takes them.

As the Paris-based project continues to evolve, Hugo Sailer's vision for Books Of Moods remains clear: to craft music that transcends time and space while rooting listeners in the emotional landscapes of their own lives. With Holidays and more releases on the horizon, the project is well on its way to establishing itself as a global indie force, resonating with anyone who craves beauty, storytelling, and soundscapes that feel like dreams made real.



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Mardi Gras' Sandcastle: An Epic Journey of Sound and Storytelling



indifferent exclusive

Cinematica

"Cinematica" grabs you instantly with its fast, distorted intro, signaling one of the album's most adventurous moments. The track's riffs are bold and inventive, interlocking with orchestral ambient layers that give it a cinematic sweep. Vocally, the performance is commanding and theatrical, elevating the song's intensity without overshadowing its instrumental complexity. There's a careful balance here between raw energy and refined artistry, making it one of the most compelling tracks on *Sandcastle*. It's a rollercoaster that navigates tension and release with precision, demonstrating Mardi Gras' skill at blending rock sensibilities with orchestral grandeur in a way that feels effortlessly organic.

Lia's Theme

Haunting and mesmerizing, "Lia's Theme" captivates with an atmosphere that is at once delicate and intense. The song holds the listener in suspended anticipation, making each note feel consequential, each pause loaded with emotion. When the vocals arrive, there is a stunning transformation: the initial tension melts into a hauntingly sweet expression that resonates long after the track ends. This interplay of sour and sweet, of tension and release, is masterfully executed. It's a moment of vulnerability within the album, showcasing the band's ability to craft soundscapes that are as emotionally rich as they are technically precise.

After The Fire

A gentle acoustic introduction ushers in "After The Fire," immediately highlighting the vocal strengths that make this album so captivating. The song's arrangement is warm and intimate, with subtle instrumental textures that support rather than overshadow the performance. Filtered vocals add a layer of softness, enhancing the track's reflective and introspective qualities. It feels like a moment of quiet revelation, a reminder of the band's versatility and depth. Within the broader context of *Sandcastle*, this track is a testament to the power of restraint—showing that an acoustic approach, when paired with evocative songwriting and heartfelt delivery, can resonate just as powerfully as full-scale production.

Cross The Line

Following a burst of album energy, "Cross The Line" arrives as a shimmering, ethereal interlude. The layering here is exquisite, with each instrumental element carefully placed to create a sense of space and depth. Vocals float effortlessly above the mix, lending the track an almost dreamlike quality. The song's pacing and arrangement make it a standout, providing contrast while maintaining cohesion with the surrounding tracks. It's a testament to Mardi Gras' meticulous production approach, where even subtle details—ambient textures, harmonics, and reverb—contribute to a lush, immersive listening experience. "Cross The Line" exemplifies the art of balancing intensity and delicacy.

Stop The Presses

"Stop The Presses" is pure cinematic rock, a track that feels both grandiose and immediate. The guitars dominate with precision and flair, driving the song forward while complementing the sweeping orchestral layers beneath. Its placement on the album feels intentional, a moment that stands out yet integrates seamlessly into the overall flow. The arrangement creates a sense of narrative momentum, making it feel like a scene in a film unfolding in real time. Vocals carry an emotional weight that grounds the track, ensuring that amidst the spectacle, the human element remains central, delivering one of the album's most memorable moments.

Wake Up

"Wake Up" serves as a refreshing oasis amid *Sandcastle*'s more intense offerings. Its calm, contemplative tone provides balance, highlighting the album's dynamic range. The song's composition is deceptively simple, yet every note and vocal inflection is purposeful, creating a sense of clarity and space. This track reminds listeners of Mardi Gras' ability to craft moments of quiet introspection without losing the album's cohesive energy. Its contrast to the heavier songs makes its presence all the more impactful, providing a breather that allows both the band and the listener to regroup before diving back into the album's epic soundscapes.

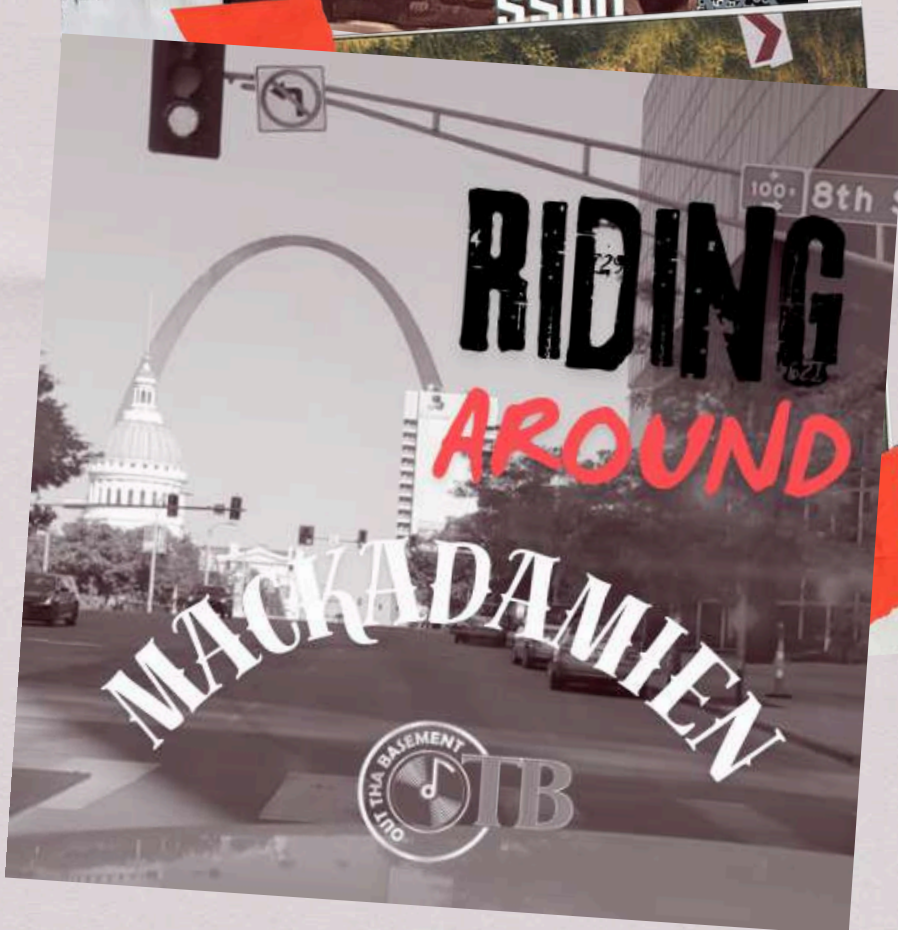
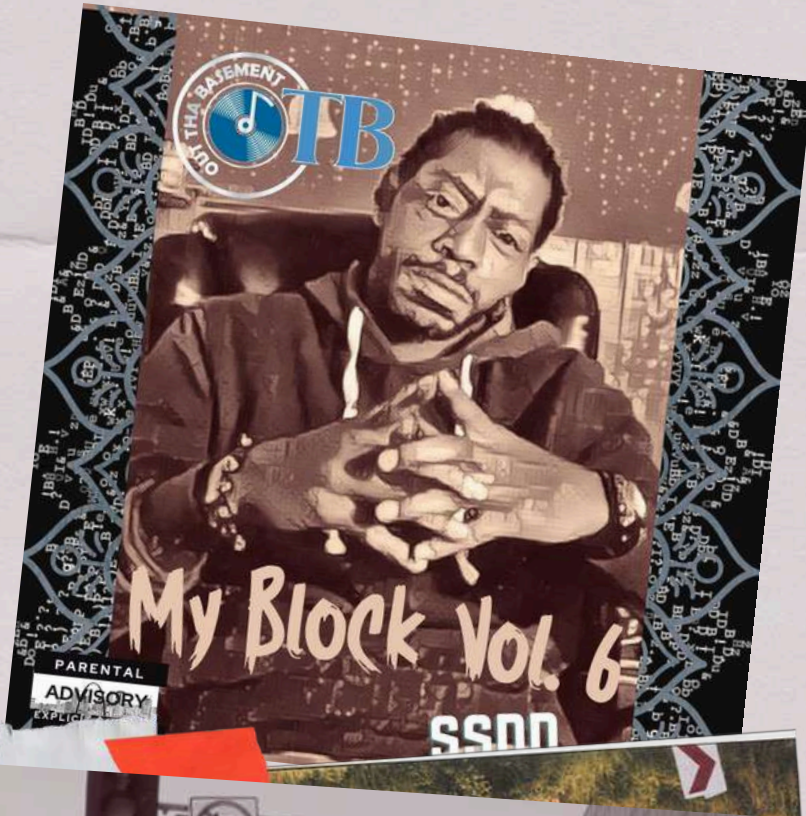
Don't Touch The Sinner

Closing the album with storytelling finesse, "Don't Touch The Sinner" is a masterclass in narrative songwriting. Vocals carry the emotional weight of the lyrics, intertwining seamlessly with arrangements that are rich yet restrained. The track encapsulates the themes of *Sandcastle*, blending reflection, drama, and catharsis into a compelling finale. Its outro lingers, offering a satisfying resolution while leaving room for interpretation, making it a perfect ending to the album's journey. This song demonstrates Mardi Gras' ability to combine technical skill with heartfelt artistry, ensuring that the final note resonates as powerfully as the first, leaving listeners both moved and captivated.



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OUT THA BASEMENT IS REWRITING THE Sound of St. Louis



In the beating heart of St. Louis, a new musical force is taking shape, reshaping the city's sonic identity with fearless creativity and uncompromising authenticity. Out Tha Basement, a tightly knit collective of some of the most gifted artists in the region, is not just making music, they are building a movement. At the center of it all stands The R.I.C.O. the exe, whose vision and direction have propelled the group into one of the most exciting creative hubs in the Midwest.

Out Tha Basement thrives on diversity of sound, drawing from an eclectic mix of influences that blur the lines between genres. The result is music that is at once unpredictable and cohesive, grounded in raw talent yet elevated by boundary-pushing experimentation. Their live performances have become the stuff of local legend, charged with energy, precision, and a sense of community that pulls audiences in and refuses to let go.

More than just a collective, Out Tha Basement functions like a creative ecosystem, with each artist contributing their own distinct style and voice to a shared body of work. It is this interplay of perspectives that gives their music its richness and staying power. They are unafraid to explore new sonic territories, knowing that evolution is not just part of the process, but the point.

With The R.I.C.O. the exe steering the vision, Out Tha Basement is not simply riding the wave of St. Louis's music scene, they are helping to shape it. Their rise feels both inevitable and deliberate, the result of years of honing craft, building connections, and embracing risk. For a city known for its deep musical roots, Out Tha Basement is a testament to how those roots can grow into something bold and entirely new. The sound may come from the basement, but its reach is destined for far beyond.

new releases



James Patrick Connell: Haunting Intensity in Imagine...

Progressive metal artist James Patrick Connell, or JPC, makes a striking entrance with his new single, *Imagine...*, set for release on September 5th. The track is a compelling collision of contrasts: ethereal, almost haunting spoken-word vocals call out repeatedly, *Can you... imagine?*, while the instrumentation unleashes a torrent of blistering guitar riffs, blast beats, and layered distortion. It feels like a signal from another dimension breaking through interference, both urgent and otherworldly.

Connell's approach reflects more than just technical skill; it embodies decades of immersion in progressive metal, where he sharpened his musicianship and explored complex sonic textures. Beginning his solo work in 2019, JPC has channeled this accumulated experience into music that is both aggressive and unconventional, merging precision with chaos. *Imagine...* exemplifies his willingness to push boundaries, offering a glimpse of an artist intent on creating immersive, emotionally charged soundscapes that linger long after the final note fades.

Nogu Svelo!: Confronting Fear with Scared of Being Afraid

Nogu Svelo! returns with *Scared of Being Afraid*, a single that confronts the subtle pressures and constraints of modern life with unflinching honesty. The track examines how unspoken rules, cancel culture, and invisible social boundaries can suffocate individuality, creating a world where people are not only hesitant to act but even afraid to feel fear itself.

Max Pokrovsky's incisive lyricism drives the song, pairing thought-provoking commentary with the band's signature energy. Explosive instrumentation propels the track forward, balancing urgency and defiance with precision, while the melodies carry a sense of rebellion and reclamation. *Scared of Being Afraid* is both a challenge and an invitation: to break silence, embrace vulnerability, and reclaim one's personal freedom. Nogu Svelo! crafts a sonic manifesto, turning confrontation into catharsis and reflection into a call to action, reminding listeners of the power of their own voice.



Friendship Commanders: BEAR Heralds a Haunting Stoner-Metal Vision

Nashville duo Friendship Commanders are set to release their new album *BEAR* on October 10 via Magnetic Eye Records, a record that channels both the weight of stoner and sludge metal and the ethereal elegance of modern alt-rock. Their sound, rooted in the sludgy, hypnotic grooves of Kyuss and Sleep, is elevated by Buick Audra's commanding riffs, which balance doom-laden intensity with melodic accessibility, creating music that is as heavy as it is compelling. Vocalist Audra's delivery floats above the instrumentation with a haunted, otherworldly quality, a contrast that has become a hallmark of the band's approach. Critics have taken note: *Rolling Stone* highlights her ethereal presence, *Brooklyn Vegan* praises the clarity and appeal of her singing alongside crushing riffs, and *Metal Injection* emphasizes the duo's urgent need for wider recognition.

Indiefferential Picks

Some of the most
interesting releases
handpicked from our
editorial team.



Windsinger Breaks Boundaries with Upbeat Summer Anthem "A Call Beyond"

Progressive rock/metal innovators Windsinger are proud to unveil their latest single, "A Call Beyond," available everywhere on August 15. Known for their intricate musicianship and adventurous songwriting, the band takes a bold new direction with this track, trading in their usual heavy edge for something brighter, bouncier, and undeniably fun.

A Call Beyond blends the band's signature progressive structures with an energetic, summer-ready vibe. Soaring guitar melodies and a propulsive rhythm section give the song an atmosphere of exhilaration, capturing the spirit of movement, exploration, and possibility.

DJ Detail Delivers a Knockout with "Haymaker" (feat. Kai-Ju)

With "Haymaker," DJ Detail brings together the raw intensity of hip-hop and the electrified punch of EDM, creating a track that feels like a fight for survival set to music. Featuring commercially licensed vocals from indie rap artist Kai-Ju, the single splices together millennial lyricism and 90s hardcore hip-hop energy, all while riding a wave of dubstep-infused production. The result? A sonic knockout punch that hits as hard as its title suggests.

Kai-Ju's verses pull no punches, lacing Muhammad Ali references with clever millennial Easter eggs that ground the song in both grit and inspiration. His flow cuts through DJ Detail's relentless production — a mix of jabs, hooks, and uppercuts of sound designed to channel adrenaline, resilience, and the will to keep swinging. At its core, "Haymaker" is motivational, urging listeners to push past obstacles and chase dreams with ferocity.

"I WANNA BE LIKE FERG" — A Bold Anthem for the Future of Music

"I WANNA BE LIKE FERG" by danXkim isn't just another track, it's a statement. Inspired by ASAP Ferg's fearless decision to go independent and take full control of his career, the song channels that same spirit of reinvention, resilience, and boundary-pushing innovation.

At its core, the single celebrates more than music. It's about the movement Ferg represents, harnessing blockchain, crypto, and AI to create a faster, fairer model for how artists get paid. By highlighting this vision, the track becomes both an anthem of empowerment and a nod to the seismic changes reshaping the music industry.



Spotify Playlist

Strange New World Set to Release Debut Album *Escape* on November 1

South Florida's rising indie rock duo, Strange New World, is ready to make their mark with the release of their highly anticipated debut LP, *Escape*, out November 1, 2024, via Strange New Music.

Strange New World is carving out their space in the modern indie rock scene by bridging eras. Their music merges the warmth of classic analog sound with the grit and energy of a modern edge, a balance that makes their debut feel both nostalgic and new.

Recorded in-house on vintage reel-to-reel tape and brought to life by Grammy-winning producer-engineer Jim Scott (known for his work on a 1973 Neve 8048 console), *Escape* embodies authenticity in both sound and spirit. The record is infused with psychedelic textures and 90's-inspired rock grooves, creating a dynamic sonic landscape designed to immerse listeners completely.

With *Escape*, Strange New World invites fans, and strangers alike, to step into their atmosphere of sound and storytelling, leaving the noise of reality behind. This album isn't just a collection of tracks; it's a gateway to a different state of mind.

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A conversation with KARNEY

Where can we find you right now and what are you up to?

You can find me on Facebook, Instagram, Bandcamp, Spotify, Apple Music, Amazon, and my website karney.org. Right now I am working on promoting One True Song, and resting. It was an intense year during the production of this album, lots of shows, and lots of life happenings. I am a choir director and guitar teacher, I have about 150 students every day, and while it is an incredibly fun and fulfilling job, it is also a very strenuous one. So I am taking time off right now.

ONE TRUE SONG showcases such a rich fusion of styles, from folk-rock to world rhythms. Tell us a bit about the creative process.

For the most part, the main idea of most of my songs comes to me all at once. That is a single lyric idea will come to mind set in its melody already. The vibe of the song is also part of that moment. Then I see if it actually works on the guitar, and if it does I start the process of sculpting a song. Some happen quickly, some are not done until I send the song to mastering. Throughout my songwriting life, many have advised me to choose a style and stick with it, but I have never felt the need to do that. Ideas are like my students, I don't play favorites, and I let them be who they are so they can develop into their most authentic selves.

You've worked with an impressive lineup of musicians on this album. What was it like collaborating with Bay Area legends like James Deprato, Uriah Duffy, and Phillip Bennet in one project?

All the musicians I work with are consummate professionals. Each one listens to my basic song ideas ahead of time and then shows up completely prepared with ideas they have already worked on. In the studio, they are positive and easy to work with. The most amazing thing about all the musicians, such as the ones you mention and bassist Kevin T. White, drummer Kyle Caprista, percussionist Faisal Zedan, and violinist Anthony Blea, they are all incredible artists in their own right. With rare exception, most songs are not just one person's idea, but the combination of artists contributing to a greater good.



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Songs like "Freedom Summer" and "Out of Body" touch on both social themes and spiritual ideas. Where do you usually draw the line between personal expression and activism in your songwriting?

I strive to be mindful of what the listener is experiencing, so I aim to strike a balance of topics on an album. It can be tough because, as I mentioned before, songs have a life of their own. That said, I might tweak an idea here or there so that the listener's ears don't tire out from me dwelling on something for too long.

You've been releasing music consistently since 1999. How do you keep your sound evolving while maintaining the core message of your artistry?

I listen to a really wide variety of music, from simple folk to symphonic music. I listen to music from North Africa and the Ivory Coast, Arabic music and South African music. I listen to Flamenco guitar, Mongolian heavy metal, and solo guitarists from around the world. I listen to very old music and very new music, always searching for a different approach.

My fascination with electronic music got me into writing for computer games and sound design, so I always have an ear out for that genre. There are some mind-blowing gospel singers, and gospel harmonies, and of course all the brilliant blues and blues-derived artists. I love the 20th-century composers who experimented with sound, rhythm, and arrangement. As for lyrics, I pay attention to the news and what is going on in the world; there is plenty to draw from there. I try to keep a fresh perspective in my own life as a growth-minded person. I don't think I will ever stop trying to discover new things; there is so much in the world that I have yet to explore.



photo by tanja nixx

What worked for you marketing-wise? What advice or tips would you give to new artists?

That's a great question. I have been in the biz since before YouTube. It wasn't easy then and it's not easy now. But there are ways to monetize your music, but you have to take it on as a full-time job to really reap the benefits that are available. Do your research, take a class, attend a workshop, connect with others in the field.

I market through email, social media, streaming platforms, retail platforms, music publications, radio, and I perform live. The old saying 'it takes money to make money' is 100%. So if you don't have money, you will have to take all this on as a full-time job yourself. That is why you really need to understand the industry and where you fit in. Marketing yourself as a rap artist will look very different than as a folk artist. If you have the resources, you can hire a team to do all these things. There are many talented individuals who can help you bring your vision to life. The music industry is probably one of the toughest to succeed in, and so far, even with the onslaught of streaming and other advanced technologies, it hasn't yet become any easier.

What do you think of AI in music?

Great music comes from the human heart. My electronic music self sees it as just another tool in the toolbox of creativity, but it should never be a substitute for human creativity. It is the human experience that makes music so important. As it is presently, it should not take the place of "authentic inspiration", the original AI. I have heard AI-generated songs, and they sound derivative and flat to me. The commercial corporate world will see AI as a way to not have to actually use/pay a musician/composer. And since commercial corporate music is derivative by design, more music jobs will be lost. Some folks say it helps them write, but AI is actually doing the writing, not the songwriter. Reading books of poetry and studying the great songwriters or composers will do that as well. And it will be more personally enriching. The best art comes from the blood, sweat, and tears of the artist, and takes time and hard work.

I don't think real human-generated music will ever stop, not as long as there is a guitar, piano, violin, clarinet, or drum to be played. One more thing to consider is that it is the power of the creative human brain that has developed and discovered things that advance civilization. Therefore, it is essential to keep our creative brains strong and not to rely too heavily on technology, so that our creative brains remain sharp.



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In the sparkling glass of contemporary film, *Highest 2 Lowest* captures not only a narrative but also a battle, a graceful fall into a man's mind. directed by a master who has danced between style and substance for years. Once more working with Denzel Washington, Spike Lee has created a movie that teeters provocatively between respect and reinvention. Rich in hidden histories and concealed ferocity, their reunion seems like a chat in a baroque salon.

The shows engage right from the first notes. Washington is magnetic as David King, a music mogul whose carefully constructed world comes undone under the weight of a kidnapping drama. Even at his most frayed, he possesses a dominant stride. His purrs and growls are said with such stylistic sophistication that we see not just a man but also an entire civilization resting on his shoulders. Equally captivating is Jeffrey Wright as Paul, the driver trapped between King's moral dilemma.

Together, their performances offer authenticity softened by the unseen burden of age, aspiration, and remorse.



This is not a simple thriller. The character arcs are inscribed with real-life ethical knots: the erratic interplay of loyalty and obligation, the rippling consequences of wealth, reputation, and parental love. The movie's textured investigation of these ideas is both intimate and broad. It urges not with didactic strength but with the grace of one who trusts the viewer to question, not to be told, even in times when its thematic compass wavers.



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Its bold visual style is where *Highest 2 Lowest* triumphs most brilliantly. Spike Lee lets his camera not only witness but also debate. Some of the most kinetic images in recent New York cinema come from a subway sequence: frenetic cuts that shatter reality, the clang of the train, the pulse of passing crowds, all choreographed with jazz-like improvisation. Light and shadow take on roles of their own, setting Washington against luxurious penthouses then in cramped public environments to remind us that his world is both magnificent and fragile. Some may argue that the conscious

tempo of the first half lingers and sometimes indulges in overstatement. Still, this deliberate unfolding, akin to a clock running, lets the audience sense the weight before the drop. For the patience it has demanded, the movie strikes harder and richer when it finally springs its trap, whether by movement, camera, or argument. The editing, especially the decision to depict events at quick-fire

angles back to back, produces a cinematographic echo chamber that enhances emotional resonance. The spectator is suspended, made accomplice in the changing viewpoints that define truth far more fluidly than any one image might communicate. A dynamic musical pulse permeates the movie as well. Matching Washington word for word, A\$AP Rocky provides an

From the Heights of Wealth to the Abyss of Moral Quandary: *Jay E. Spivey* *Highest 2 Lowest*



cliches, erratic emotional incongruity, and an uneven tone. Sometimes its moral weight threatens to eclipse the subtlety of the narrative. Others find theatrical overreach situations, portraying a collision of high-art direction and stylistic changes that disrupt the beat. Still, the general impression is kind. *Highest 2 Lowest* is a moral thriller both opulent and relentless that requires not just attention

unforgettable bad character turn in a rap battle that strikes half tragic dance, half verbal boxing match. Carried by Aiyana-Lee's haunting title track, the conclusion comes not with bombastic grandeur but with heartbreaking understatement. Her voice, gentle yet determined, closes the story with a lasting elegy. Still, not all of the movie's detractors can be dismissed. Some charge it with

but also empathy. Its ambition is in its flaws. Long after the credits finish rolling, it pulls at the conscience rejecting the solace of resolution.



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